

Complete Theme

Vocabulary — 24 words

Word	IPA	Turkish	Example
landmark <i>noun</i>	/ˈləndmɑːrk/	simge yapı, önemli yer	The old clock tower is a well-known landmark in the city centre.
monument <i>noun</i>	/ˈmɒnjumənt/	anıt	The monument was built to honour the soldiers who died in the war.
ancient <i>adjective</i>	/ˈeɪnfənt/	antik, eski	Visitors are amazed by the ancient walls that still surround the old city.
civilisation <i>noun</i>	/ˌsɪvələɪ ˈzeɪʃn/	medeniyet	Several civilisations have left their mark on this region over the centuries.
site <i>noun</i>	/saɪt/	yer, alan	The archaeological site is protected by law and cannot be built on.
ruins <i>noun</i>	/ˈruːnz/	kalıntılar, harabeler	The ruins of the old theatre attract thousands of tourists every year.
heritage <i>noun</i>	/ˈherɪtɪdʒ/	miras	The site was added to the list of world heritage in the 1980s.
preserve <i>verb</i>	/prɪˈzɜːrv/	korumak	Special teams work to preserve the ancient mosaics from damage.
restore <i>verb</i>	/rɪˈstɔːr/	restore etmek, onarmak	The palace has been restored several times over the past century.
construct <i>verb</i>	/kənˈstrʌkt/	inşa etmek	The bridge was constructed using stone brought from a nearby quarry.
architect <i>noun</i>	/ˈɑːrkɪtekt/	mimar	The mosque was designed by a famous architect of the period.
discover <i>verb</i>	/dɪˈskʌvər/	keşfetmek	The underground city was discovered by accident in the 1960s.
excavate <i>verb</i>	/ˈɛkskəveɪt/	kazı yapmak	Archaeologists have been excavating the area for over twenty years.
inscription <i>noun</i>	/ɪnˈskrɪpʃn/	kitabe, yazıt	An old inscription on the wall describes the founding of the city.
dome <i>noun</i>	/doʊm/	kubbe	The huge dome can be seen from almost every part of the old city.

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fortress <i>noun</i>	/ˈfɔːrtɹəs/	kale	The fortress was used to defend the coast from sea attacks.
formation <i>noun</i>	/fɔːrˈmeɪʃn/	oluşum	The unusual rock formations were shaped by wind and rain over millions of years.
erosion <i>noun</i>	/ɪˈrouʒn/	erozyon, aşınma	The strange shapes of the valley were created by centuries of erosion.
attraction <i>noun</i>	/əˈtrækʃn/	cazibe merkezi	The underground city has become one of the region's biggest attractions.
founded <i>adjective/verb</i>	/ˈfaʊndɪd/	kurulmuş	The city was founded more than two thousand years ago.
settlement <i>noun</i>	/ˈsetlmənt/	yerleşim	Archaeologists believe this was one of the earliest human settlements in the area.
carve <i>verb</i>	/kɑːrv/	oymak	Rooms and churches were carved directly into the soft volcanic rock.
landscape <i>noun</i>	/ˈləndskeɪp/	manzara, peyzaj	The unusual landscape draws hot air balloon visitors from all over the world.
authentic <i>adjective</i>	/ɔːˈθentɪk/	otantik, gerçek	Visitors say the old town still feels authentic and untouched by modern life.

The Passive Voice (Present Simple, Past Simple, Present/Past Continuous, Future, and Modals)

The passive voice is formed with the correct tense of the verb 'be' + the past participle of the main verb. We use it when the action itself, or the thing the action happens to, is more important than who performs it. The form changes according to tense: present simple (is/are + p.p.), past simple (was/were + p.p.), present continuous (is/are being + p.p.), past continuous (was/were being + p.p.), future simple (will be + p.p.), and with modals (modal + be + p.p.).

Edilgen çatı (passive voice), doğru zamandaki 'be' fiili + ana fiilin geçmiş zaman ortacı (past participle) ile oluşturulur. Eylemi kimin yaptığından çok, eylemin kendisi veya eylemin yapıldığı şey önemliyse kullanılır. Zamana göre biçimi değişir: geniş zaman (is/are + p.p.), geçmiş zaman (was/were + p.p.), şimdiki zamanın sürekli hali (is/are being + p.p.), geçmiş zamanın sürekli hali (was/were being + p.p.), gelecek zaman (will be + p.p.) ve kiplerle birlikte (modal + be + p.p.).

When? We use the passive voice when describing historic facts (who built something is unknown or unimportant), when talking about processes happening to a place now (restoration, repair), when describing future plans for a site, and when giving rules or recommendations about protecting a place.

Edilgen çatıyı; tarihi bir gerçeği anlatırken (bir şeyi kimin yaptığı bilinmiyorsa veya önemli değilse), bir yere şu anda uygulanan bir süreçten (restorasyon, onarım) bahsederken, bir yer için gelecek planlarından söz ederken ve bir yeri korumaya dair kural ya da tavsiye verirken kullanırız.

Positive

- The castle is built on a hill. (present simple)
- The temple was built in ancient times. (past simple)
- The road is being repaired this week. (present continuous)
- The site was being excavated when the war began. (past continuous)
- A new sign will be placed at the entrance. (future simple)
- This monument must be respected by all visitors. (modal)

Negative

- The museum is not opened on Mondays.
- The gate was not damaged during the storm.
- The hall is not being used at the moment.
- The statue will not be moved to another city.
- Photographs must not be taken inside the tomb.

Question

- Is the palace visited by many tourists?
- Was the bridge built by local engineers?
- Is the site currently being restored?
- Will the exhibition be opened next month?
- Should this area be protected?

Short answers

- Yes, it is. / No, it isn't.
- Yes, it was. / No, it wasn't.
- Yes, it is. / No, it isn't.
- Yes, it will. / No, it won't.
- Yes, it should. / No, it shouldn't.

Common mistakes

- ~~The castle built in the 14th century.~~ → **The castle was built in the 14th century.**

• ~~The museum is visit by many people.~~ → **The museum is visited by many people.**

• ~~The ruins were discover last year.~~ → **The ruins were discovered last year.**

• ~~This area must protected.~~ → **This area must be protected.**

1. The Trojan Horse story _____ (know) all over the world.

2. This ancient theatre _____ (build) more than two thousand years ago.

3. Choose the correct passive form: 'The old walls _____ right now.'

- a. are repairing
- b. are being repaired
- c. were repaired
- d. repair

4. 'The site was discover by a shepherd.' is correct. — *True / False*

5. Which sentence correctly uses a modal in the passive?

- a. This area should protect.
- b. This area should be protect.
- c. This area should be protected.
- d. This area should protected be.

6. Rewrite in the passive: 'They will open a new museum next year.' (*A new museum ...*)

7. Look, the entrance _____ (paint) at the moment, so we can't go in.

8. Put the words in order: was / famous / the / restored / mosque / last year

9. Rewrite in the passive: 'Archaeologists are excavating the ruins this summer.' (*The ruins ...*)

10. Choose the best passive sentence for: 'They should not remove the old inscriptions.'

- a. The old inscriptions should not be removed.
- b. The old inscriptions should not removed.
- c. The old inscriptions not should be removed.
- d. The old inscriptions should be not removed.

11. When the earthquake struck, the temple _____ (rebuild) by local workers.

An Underground City

Before you read

- Have you ever heard of a city built entirely underground?
- What do you think life might have been like living below the surface?

In the region of Cappadocia, in central Türkiye, several underground cities can be found carved into the soft volcanic rock. One of the largest of these was discovered almost by accident in 1963, when a local resident knocked down a wall in his house and found a hidden tunnel behind it. Since then, many chambers, corridors and rooms have been uncovered by archaeologists.

It is believed that the underground city was first used thousands of years ago as a place of shelter. Over time, rooms were carved deeper and deeper into the rock, and the settlement was gradually expanded until it could hold thousands of people along with their animals and food supplies. Stables, kitchens, storage rooms and even small churches were built several levels below the ground.

Large round stones were used as doors, and these could be rolled across the entrances from the inside to block invaders. Fresh air was supplied through a clever system of ventilation shafts that also reached the surface, and wells were dug to provide clean water even during long periods underground.

Today, only a small part of the underground city is open to visitors, since new tunnels and rooms are still being explored. It has become one of the most popular attractions in the region, and it is visited by travellers from all over the world who want to see how people once lived beneath the earth.

1. When was the underground city discovered?

- a. In ancient times
- b. In 1963
- c. Last year
- d. It has never been discovered

2. The underground city was used only for one day at a time. — *True / False*

3. Large round stones were used as _____ that could be rolled across entrances.

4. How was fresh air supplied to the underground city?

- a. Through open windows
- b. Through ventilation shafts
- c. It was not supplied
- d. Through the main entrance only

5. Rewrite this sentence in the passive: 'People are still exploring new tunnels and rooms.' (*New tunnels and rooms ...*)

6. Why is only a small part of the underground city open to visitors?

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- a. It is too dangerous
 - b. New tunnels and rooms are still being explored
 - c. It is closed for repairs
 - d. Tourists are not allowed inside

After you read

- Would you like to visit an underground city like this? Why or why not?
- What other reasons might people have had for building homes underground?

A City Built on Water

Before you read

- Do you know of any famous cities built on water or beside a strait?
- What difficulties do you think a city built between two seas might have?

Istanbul is one of the few cities in the world that is built on two continents, with the Bosphorus strait dividing its European and Asian sides. For thousands of years, the city has been ruled by different empires, and each civilisation has left behind its own buildings, walls and monuments.

The old city walls, parts of which can still be seen today, were originally constructed to protect the city from land and sea attacks. Massive gates were built into the walls, and guards were once stationed at each one to check everyone entering the city. Although much of the wall has been damaged over the centuries, sections of it have been carefully restored so that visitors can imagine how strong the defences once were.

One of the city's most famous buildings began its life as a church, was later converted into a mosque, and for many years was used as a museum before being reopened as a mosque again. Its enormous dome, which amazed visitors when it was completed, is still considered an outstanding achievement of engineering.

Today, bridges and tunnels connect the two sides of the city, and thousands of commuters cross the strait every single day. Ferries are still used by many people, partly because they are convenient and partly because the crossing offers wonderful views of the city's skyline. New museums and cultural centres are being opened all the time, which shows that this ancient city continues to change while its history is carefully preserved.

1. What divides the European and Asian sides of the city described?

- a. A mountain range
- b. The Bosphorus strait
- c. A desert
- d. A large lake

2. The old city walls were originally built to _____ the city from attacks.

3. The famous domed building described has always been used only as a mosque. — *True / False*

4. How do most commuters cross between the two sides of the city today?

- a. Only by ferry
- b. By bridges, tunnels, and ferries
- c. By walking across the strait
- d. The crossing is not possible

5. Rewrite in the passive: 'People are opening new museums all the time.' (*New museums ...*)

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After you read

- What do you think makes a city special when it is built between two continents?
- Which parts of a city's history do you think are most important to preserve?

A Guided Tour of a Historic Site

Before you listen

- What questions would you ask a guide during a tour of a historic site?
- What kind of information do tour guides usually give visitors?

1. When was the fortress originally built?

- a. In the fifteenth century
- b. Last year
- c. In the twentieth century
- d. It is not mentioned

2. The fortress has _____ towers in total.

3. Visitors can go up to the top tower today. — *True / False*

4. What will happen at the site next year?

- a. The fortress will be closed permanently
- b. A new visitor centre will be opened
- c. All the towers will be removed
- d. It will become a private house

5. Where is photography not permitted?

- a. In the towers
- b. In the old chapel
- c. Outside the fortress
- d. Everywhere

The Story of a Natural Wonder

Before you listen

- Can you think of a place where unusual rock or land shapes were formed naturally?
- How do you think such shapes might be created over time?

1. What are the cone-shaped rock formations often called?

- a. Stone giants
- b. Fairy chimneys
- c. Rock towers
- d. Sky pillars

2. The formations were created by _____ eruptions millions of years ago.

3. The rock formations are not protected and visitors may damage them freely. — *True / False*

4. What can visitors do to see the landscape from above?

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- ☐ a. Climb a tower
- ☐ b. Take a hot air balloon ride
- ☐ c. Use a telescope
- ☐ d. Visit a museum

Describe a Landmark

Pairs · 8-10 min

Choose a real or imaginary Turkish landmark. Describe it to your partner using at least four passive voice sentences (when it was built, what it is used for, how it is protected, and any future plans).

Useful language: It was built in..., It is visited by..., It is currently being..., It will be..., It must be protected because...

1. Choose a landmark and note down four to five key facts.
2. Turn each fact into a passive voice sentence.
3. Take turns describing your landmark to your partner.
4. Your partner listens and asks one follow-up question for more detail.

Ask for More Detailed Information

Groups of 3-4 · 10 min

One student plays a tour guide describing a historic site; the others ask follow-up questions to get more detailed information, such as dates, numbers, or future plans.

Useful language: Could you tell me more about...?, What exactly is being done to...?, When was it...?, How many...are there?, Is anything planned for...?

1. The 'guide' prepares three or four basic facts about a site.
2. The guide gives a short introduction to the group.
3. The other students ask at least three follow-up questions.
4. The guide answers using the passive voice where possible.
5. Switch roles so everyone has a turn as the guide.

Writing

Describe a Historic Site

120-150 words

Write a short factual text about a real or imaginary historic site in Türkiye. Include when it was built, what it is used for today, and how it is being protected or restored.

Plan:

1. List the key facts you want to include.
2. Decide which tense each fact needs (past, present, future, or modal).
3. Organise the facts into a logical order: history, present, future/protection.

Checklist:

- ☐ I have used at least four different passive forms.
- ☐ I have included at least one date or number.
- ☐ My text follows a clear order: past, present, future.
- ☐ I have checked my spelling and punctuation.

Compare Two Sites

150-180 words

Write a short comparison of two historic or natural sites in Türkiye, using the passive voice to describe how each was built, discovered, or formed, and how each is treated today.

Plan:

1. Choose two sites and note two or three facts about each.
2. Group facts by category: origin, present use, protection.
3. Use linking words to compare and contrast the two sites.

Checklist:

- ☐ I have described both sites using the passive voice.
- ☐ I have used at least two linking words to compare them.
- ☐ I have organised my paragraph clearly.
- ☐ I have checked my grammar and vocabulary.

1. This castle _____ (build) over five hundred years ago.
2. Choose the correct passive: 'The bridge _____ by engineers right now.'
 - a. is repairing
 - b. is being repaired
 - c. repairs
 - d. was repaired
3. 'The site is visit by thousands of tourists.' is correct. — *True / False*
4. What is a 'landmark'?
 - a. A type of food
 - b. A well-known place or structure
 - c. A kind of weather
 - d. A musical instrument
5. Special teams work to _____ (preserve) the ancient mosaics from damage.
6. In the reading about the underground city, how was it discovered?
 - a. By archaeologists on purpose
 - b. Almost by accident, by a resident
 - c. By tourists
 - d. It has not been discovered yet
7. In the listening about the fortress, why is the top tower closed?
 - a. It has collapsed
 - b. It is currently being repaired
 - c. It was sold
 - d. There is no reason given
8. Rewrite in the passive: 'They will open a new museum next spring.' (*A new museum ...*)
9. Put the words in order: restored / recently / been / the / walls / have
10. Which question correctly asks for more detailed information?
 - a. You tell me more about it?
 - b. Could you tell me more about it?
 - c. Tell more me about it?
 - d. More about it could you tell?

Support

1. Write four sentences about a landmark using the passive voice, choosing the correct verb from a given list.
2. Match 8 vocabulary words from this theme to their Turkish meanings.
3. Complete five gap-fill sentences using 'was built', 'is visited', or 'will be opened'.
4. Read one short paragraph about a landmark and answer three true/false questions.

Core

1. Write a short paragraph (100-120 words) describing a real Turkish landmark using at least five passive sentences.
2. Choose 10 vocabulary words from this theme and write an original sentence for each.
3. Complete eight passive voice practice sentences covering different tenses and one modal.
4. Prepare three follow-up questions you could ask a guide about a historic site.

Extension

1. Write a 150-180 word comparison of two historic or natural sites in Türkiye using a range of passive tenses.
2. Research (using only general knowledge, not copying any source) one UNESCO site in Türkiye and write five original facts about it in the passive voice.
3. Write a short guide script (as if for tourists) introducing a landmark, including at least two modal passive sentences.
4. Create your own set of five passive voice practice questions for a classmate to answer.

Vocabulary

1. What does 'heritage' mean?
 - a. A type of building material
 - b. Something passed down from the past, like culture or monuments
 - c. A modern invention
 - d. A kind of tourist ticket
2. Archaeologists have been _____ (excavate) the site for over twenty years.
3. Which word means 'to build something'?
 - a. discover
 - b. construct
 - c. erode
 - d. restore

Grammar

1. The temple _____ (visit) by thousands of people every year.
2. Choose the correct passive form: 'The rooms _____ carved into the rock centuries ago.'
 - a. are
 - b. were
 - c. is
 - d. was
3. Rewrite in the passive: 'Workers are restoring the old walls this month.' (*The old walls ...*)
4. 'This site must protected by law.' is correct. — *True / False*

Reading

1. According to the reading about the underground city, what were used as doors?
 - a. Wooden panels
 - b. Large round stones
 - c. Metal gates
 - d. Curtains
2. In the second reading, the city's famous domed building was first used as a _____.

Listening

1. In the fortress guided tour, how many towers have recently been restored?

- a. One
- b. Two
- c. Three
- d. Twelve

2. In the natural wonder listening, the rock formations were made by wind alone. — *True / False*